mindful health solutions
INNOVATIVE BEHAVIORAL HEALTH SERVICES

Name of Patient: _____

DOB of Patient: _____

Clinic Location: _____

KETAMINE TREATMENT CONSENT

Welcome to our practice. This document contains important information about medical and professional services. Please read and ask any questions you might have so that we can discuss.

I voluntarily seek and consent to Ketamine treatment from an MHS psychiatrist, nurse or nurse practitioner, or other provider or designee. I agree they may perform reasonable and necessary medical services, assessments, testing and Ketamine treatment.

This consent contains information about the use of ketamine therapy for the treatment of depression and other psychiatric illnesses. Ketamine has been approved by the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) for use as an anesthetic agent. The use of ketamine in lower doses to treat depression is a newer, *off-label* use of ketamine. It is usually used after other treatments have been unsuccessful.

While ketamine is not formally approved by the FDA to treat depression, there are studies that say it may be an effective treatment option for multiple disorders, including major depressive disorder.

OVERVIEW OF KETAMINE TREATMENT

Ketamine can be given as an intravenous (IV) injection or drip, or as an intramuscular (IM) injection. For IV treatment, an intravenous catheter is placed, and ketamine is infused. You will remain awake and able to talk during the procedure, but your perception and mental state will likely be altered by the ketamine. You will return to a normal mental state as the medication effects wear off.

You may ask your provider any questions you may have concerning the procedure or effects of ketamine at any time. Your consent to receive ketamine may be withdrawn by you, and you may discontinue your participation at any time up until the actual dose has been administered.

CONTRAINDICATIONS TO KETAMINE THERAPY

Ketamine therapy should not be used in patients with the following:

- Psychosis
- Active suicidal ideation or plans
- Increased intracranial pressure (ICP), current or past
- Uncontrolled high blood pressure (hypertension) or angina
- Unstable heart rhythm
- Active alcohol or substance use
- Pregnancy or breastfeeding
- Untreated hyperthyroidism
- Aneurysmal vascular disease
- Liver disease
- Prior hypersensitivity or negative reaction to ketamine

POSSIBLE SIDE EFFECTS OCCURRING DURING KETAMINE THERAPY

Most side effects are brief or subside as the medication wears off.

- Impaired balance and coordination
- Sleepiness or fatigue
- Headaches
- Nausea or vomiting, loss of appetite
- Blurred or double vision
- Slurred speech
- Confusion, excitability, anxiety
- Impaired ability to see, hear or feel things accurately, or hallucinations
- Bad taste in mouth, reduced sense of touch
- Altered sense of time
- Elevated pulse or blood pressure
- Nystagmus (rapid eye movements) – rare
- Elevated intraocular pressure (increased pressure in the eyes) – rare
- Allergic reactions – rare
- Any altered state of consciousness produced by ketamine usually lasts approximately 30 minutes after the infusion but can last longer.
- The impaired sense of balance, dizziness and possible nausea gradually subside over three to six hours. **Patients should not drive themselves home after ketamine treatment.**
- Because of the risk of nausea and vomiting, **please refrain from eating and drinking for at least 6 hours before your session.** If you are unduly nauseated during treatment, you may be offered an anti-nausea medication.
- Ketamine can cause a significant increase in blood pressure or heart rate (pulse). If monitoring shows this has occurred, you may be offered medication to lower your blood pressure or heart rate.
- Agitation may occur during a ketamine session. If you are uncomfortable, you may be offered medication to help you relax.
- Chronic, high-dose recreational abuse of ketamine can cause urinary tract symptoms and even permanent bladder dysfunction, though no significant effects have been reported with medical use.

Risks of having an IV placed:

- Mild discomfort at the placement site
- Fainting
- Bruising
- Bleeding
- Infection

POTENTIAL FOR KETAMINE ABUSE AND PHYSICAL DEPENDENCE

Ketamine is a controlled substance and is subject to Schedule III rules under the Controlled Substances Act of 1970. Medical evidence regarding the issue of drug abuse and dependence suggests that ketamine's abuse potential is low risk when medically prescribed. Ketamine should never be used except under the supervision of a licensed physician. Ketamine abuse has been known to cause unusual thoughts, hallucinations, ulcerative or interstitial cystitis, long-term cognitive impairment, liver damage, addiction, and death in people who abuse ketamine for recreational purposes.

SUICIDAL IDEATION

Psychiatric illnesses carry the risk of suicidal ideation (thoughts of ending one's life). Any such thoughts you may have now, at any time during the weeks of your ketamine infusions, or at any point in the future, which cannot be immediately addressed by visiting with a mental health professional, should prompt you to seek emergency care or to call 911 or 988.

IMPORTANT: If you are experiencing a psychiatric emergency, a life-threatening emergency, and/or medication side effects causing shortness of breath, heart problems, severe rash, or other life-threatening concerns, please call 911 or go to your nearest emergency room. If you have any thoughts of harming yourself or others, please go to your nearest emergency room or dial 911. The 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline (formerly the National Suicide Prevention Lifeline) is available 24 hours a day by calling 988. This is a national network of local crisis centers that provides free and confidential emotional support to people in suicidal or emotional crisis.

INFORMED CONSENT

By signing this consent, I agree that:

1. I understand that I am to have no food or drink for 6 hours prior to my ketamine session.
2. I fully understand that ketamine sessions can result in a brief but profound change in mental state or in unusual psychological and physiological effects. I will leave the clinic only when I am sufficiently recovered from the infusion state.
3. I understand that I may need to have someone drive me home from the sessions, and I will not engage in driving or hazardous activity without at least one night's sleep after treatment.
4. I give my consent to the use of additional medications if deemed necessary to treat agitation, high blood pressure or high pulse rate.
5. I have the right to discuss all medical treatments with my clinician. Please discuss with us if you have any questions or uncertainty about whether to continue treatment.
6. There are no guarantees being made to me as to the results of any evaluation or ketamine treatment.
7. I am an active participant in this endeavor and share the responsibility for treatment by providing information about myself that is as accurate as I can.

Specifically, I understand:

a. IV ketamine is not an FDA-approved treatment for major depressive disorder, bipolar disorder, post-traumatic stress disorder or obsessive-compulsive disorder.

b. Ketamine will be administered intravenously by a provider or a nurse under the supervision of a physician.

c. To be effective, ketamine may need to be administered repeatedly, and some patients may experience benefits in less time while other patients may take longer to respond.

d. Even if effective, the effects of ketamine may not be permanent, and some form of subsequent or ongoing treatment may be necessary.

e. As with any medical treatment, side effects may occur.

f. I will arrange for a safe ride home after each appointment and will not drive or use heavy machinery for the rest of the day on which I receive ketamine.

g. This consent is valid for the duration of the treatment, but I may revoke all or any part of this authorization at any time.

h. I am responsible for the costs of treatment regardless of treatment outcome.

i. This practice and MHS have an outcomes database. Outcomes, demographic variables and information regarding treatment history are entered in the repository, and information from the database may be shared for educational, research or other purposes. No protected health information (PHI) that identifies individuals is entered in the database.

TREATMENT CONSENT

I have fully read this informed consent form describing IV ketamine therapy. I have had the opportunity to ask and raise questions and have received satisfactory answers. I understand the risks and benefits, and I freely give my consent to participate.

By signing below, you confirm that you have read and understand the terms stated in this Treatment Consent.

Patient

Signature: _____

Printed Name: _____

Date: _____

Parent or Guardian (if applicable)

In order to authorize mental health treatment for your child, you must have either sole or joint legal custody of your child. In the course of our treatment of your child, we may meet with the child's parents/guardians either separately or together. Please be aware, however, that at all times our patient is your child – not the parents/guardians nor any siblings or other family members of the child.

Signature: _____

Printed Name: _____

Date: _____

Provider

Signature: _____

Printed Name: _____

Date: _____

CONTACT INFORMATION

Please call (844) 867-8444 to contact us. When you leave a message, please state your name clearly, your phone number(s) (even if you think we have it), the reason for calling, and let us know when the best time is to contact you. Messages left late in the day, on weekends or holidays may not be returned until the next business day.